Lecture Note 8: SDI AND TRANSLATION SERVICES, ETC

1. Selective Dissemination of Information (SDI)

Selective Dissemination of Information (SDI) is a personalized, active information service that aims to keep users informed of new resources (documents, articles, reports, etc.) relevant to their specific fields of interest. It is essentially a tailored "current awareness" service.

Also, Selective dissemination of information (SDI) refers to the automatic and targeted distribution of information about individuals based on their specific interests and preferences. It is a concept rooted in science and information technology and aims to filter and deliver relevant content to users in an efficient manner. SDI systems have been developed to deal with the increasing volume of information available and offer personalized information retrieval and delivery.

SDI are also services provided by a library or other information agency whereby its users are periodically notified of new publications, report literature, or other sources of information in subjects in which they have specified an interest.

OBJECTIVES of SDI

To provide current information on a particular subject

To receive, scan, and provide literature to right users.

To notify the latest information about a particular subject clearly.

To delegate the computer base techniques for relating current profile of information to the interest of users.

To achieve current requirements through the scan of journals, current awareness bulletin, and other important resources.

Key Components of SDI

- **User Profile**: A detailed record of a user's interests' subject areas, keywords, academic level, and preferred format of information. This profile is often created through interviews or an analysis of the user's past research.

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- **Document Profile**: A record for each new item acquired by the library/information center, containing descriptive metadata like keywords, abstract, author, and subject headings.
- **Matching Process:** The core of the service. A system (traditionally manual, now largely computerized) compares the User Profile with the Document Profile.
- **Dissemination/Alerts**: When a match is found, the relevant information (often the abstract, table of contents, or a citation) is sent directly to the user via email, RSS feed, text message, or a personalized web portal.
- **Feedback**: The user often provides feedback on the relevance of the sent information, which is used to refine and update their User Profile for future searches, making the service increasingly accurate (Adaptive Learning).

Role and Importance

- Saves Time: Filters out irrelevant information, allowing researchers to focus only on highly pertinent new developments.
- Ensures Comprehensiveness: Helps users stay current in their field, preventing them from missing critical new research.
- Personalized Service: Caters to the individual's specific needs, which is especially valuable in academic or special libraries.

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TRANSLATION SERVICES

Translation is conversion of one language into another language but retaining the original sense.

Translation is also the process of transferring the information contents of the text in one language (L1) into another language (L2). The former (L1) is called the ***'Source Language (SL)'*** and the latter (L2) is called the ***'Target Language (TL)'***.

In the translation process, the language expert analyses the given text in the source language from various viewpoints including meaning, grammatical structure of the sentence(s), terminology, etc. and comprehends the information contents of the sentence(s). The more accurate the comprehension of the information contents of the sentence(s), the more precise will be its transfer in target language. If the translator fails to understand the message communicated by the source language, the information transferred into target language will either be distorted or inadequate. A translator, therefore, should have sufficient knowledge of the source language as well as of the target language. In addition, s/he should be a subject expert to understand the terminology of the given subject. Each discipline has its own peculiar jargons and terms and a good translator should have in depth knowledge of these terms in both languages. Thus, subject knowledge is an essential requirement for translation.

In the context of libraries and information centers, translation Services are provided to eliminate language as a barrier to accessing global knowledge.

Objectives of Translation Services:

Some of the main objectives of translation services are as follows:

a) to provide a document in user language

b) to save the time of researchers, scientists and other scholars

c) to promote the use of documents

d) to promote cultural understanding

e) Establishment of cooperation and co-ordination with international organizations, agencies etc.

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Types of Translation Services:

Translation may be of following types

1. Cover-to-Cover Translation: A cover-to-cover translation is a complete translation of the document. It is generally confined to worthwhile journals. Such journals should be selected by National Translation Centre (NTS) in consultation with the subject specialist engaged in various Research & Development work in various institutions.

The main advantage of cover-to-cover translation is that it ensures the availability of important scientific literature irrespective of language barriers. It also eliminates the hit miss selection of articles. One of the drawbacks of cover-to-cover translation is time lag. Time lag is the gap between publishing of a journal in its original language and its translated version. Sometimes, it ranges from six months to one year or even more.

2. Selective Translation: A selective translation, as the name indicates, is a translation of selected parts of a document. This can include translations of tables of contents, lead paragraphs, abstracts, conclusions, or the sections of key interest.

When is a Selective Translation appropriate?

A selective translation is appropriate when :

i) We want to know the general content of a document, yet there are time constraints and/or we

have to operate under a limited budget;

ii) We are certain which parts of the document you want translated, and can indicate this clearly on the copy provided. Only the indicated segments are then translated;

iii. We know broadly what the document is about, but need to extract only certain information from it.

iv) We define what we want to know on the relevant subject matter, and we will identify and translate the appropriate sections.

3. Document Translation: Providing a full written translation of a document, article, or book chapter. This is often outsourced to qualified human translators for high-quality, technical, or legal content, though machine translation is increasingly used for initial drafts or less critical content.

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4.Abstract/Summary Translation: Translating only the summary, abstract, or table of contents of a foreign-language document to help the user assess its relevance before committing to a full translation.

5. Catalogue/Metadata Translation: Translating the titles, subject headings, and other descriptive information in the library catalog or databases to make foreign-language materials discoverable by multilingual users.

6. Spoken/Interpretation Services: Providing real-time interpretation for library-user interactions, especially in public libraries serving diverse linguistic communities.

Role and Importance

- Enhances Access to Global Knowledge: Allows researchers and students to benefit from international scholarly works published in non-native languages.
- Promotes Inclusivity: Ensures that users from diverse linguistic backgrounds can fully utilize the library's collections and services.
- Supports Academic Research: Crucial for literature reviews and accessing niche or specialized information only available in foreign sources.

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